cooperation with foreign intelligence services. The preference was for “blue and white” operations whenever possible. A joint strike with a foreign service was chosen only when there was no other way to do it or when the risks involved in acting alone were too high.

A few more insights on the subject of prevention: great powers can afford not to engage in thwarting their adversaries’ capabilities. They can make do with building up deterrence against the enemy. Deterrence in this context means convincing the adversary that if he utilizes his abilities, the price he is liable to pay will be beyond what he can withstand. Small countries like Israel cannot adopt a strategy that relies solely on deterrence. In the case of Israel, even a combination of deterrence and the ability to achieve a decisive victory is not sufficient, especially in dealings with coalitions of enemy states, since Israel’s territory is extremely small and its military and economic power is concentrated in a relatively small area, which does not allow it to develop and maintain the capacity to absorb blows. Israel must refrain from entering wars whose end cannot be seen on the horizon. A notable example of this was the Yom Kippur War in 1973. The war began on October 6. Sixteen days later, on October 22, a considerable number of IDF forces were already stationed west of the Suez Canal, having reached a distance of 101 kilometers from the Egyptian capital of Cairo. On the northern front, IDF artillery seized positions that would have allowed them to shell the center of the Syrian capital of Damascus. But the two Arab rulers, Sadat and Assad, made no sign of desiring a cease-fire. On the contrary, Sadat expressed in internal conversations that Israel would not be able to withstand a war of attrition, something that greatly disturbed Israel’s political and military leadership. The historical fact is that US secretary of state Henry Kissinger and the premier of the Soviet Union, Alexei Kosygin, agreed on a cease-fire during a secret meeting in Moscow. Kosygin forced the cease-fire on Sadat, assuring him that he had received a commitment from Kissinger that the United States would be able to pull the IDF out of its positions. As for Syria, which had emerged from the war battered and its capital Damascus threatened, it had no choice but to agree to a cease-fire rather than to stand alone against Israel. Moreover, the Russians had promised the Syrians that they would rebuild their army. The Israeli leadership breathed a sigh of relief when the threat of a war of attrition was lifted.